

Owen Hejna

Ecologist and Educator

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Website · LinkedIn · GitHub

Education

B.S., Ecology Loyola University Chicago University Research: Laboratory of Bioinformatics, Laboratory of Aquatic Ecology, Urban Agriculture Program	Graduated <i>cum laude</i> , May 2024
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Experience

Volunteer Engagement Coordinator Indiana Audubon Society, Independent Contractor Role	Since August 2026
Secretive Marshbird Coordinator Indiana Audubon Society, Independent Contractor Role	Since February 2026
Program Instructor II Evanston Ecology Center, Evanston, IL	Since February 2026
Community Science Coordinator Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL	April – December 2025
Summer Research Intern Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL	June – September 2024
DNA Barcoding of Neotropical Fishes Intern The Field Museum, Chicago, IL	June – August 2023
Shoreline Maintenance Technician Chicago Botanic Garden, Glencoe, IL	June – August 2022

Certifications

Bird Guide Ambassador Indiana Audubon	Issued Aug 2026
Adult First Aid CPR/AED All Ages Health and Safety Institute	Issued Jun 2026
Acoustic Bat Call Identification Vesper Bat Detection Services	Issued May 2025
Mandated Reporter Illinois Department of Children and Family Services	Issued May 2025

Organization Affiliations

Midwest Society for Acoustic Ecology Member	Since May 2026
Illinois Bat Working Group Member	Since March 2026
Urban Wildlife Institute GIS Analyst, Acoustic Analyst	Since January 2026
Chicago Ornithological Society (COS) Calumet Conservation Committee, MAPS Bird Bander (2026)	Since November 2025
Urban Rivers Educator and Trip Leader	Since June 2025
National Society of Collegiate Scholars Member	2020 – 2024

Scientific Articles

Planet Forward Chicago's people-powered Bat Tracker: Citizen scientists seek a different bat signal	Published October 2025
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Selected Presentations

Marshbird Monitoring in the Calumet Urban Birding Festival	Presented September 2026
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Attended Events

Urban Birding Festival Presenter, Trip Guide	September 2026
Indiana Dunes Birding Festival Trip Guide	May 2026
Midwest Bat Working Group Annual Meeting	April 2026
Urban Wildlife Information Network Summit	September 2025
Midwest Beaver Summit	August 2024